

5. Resources

The idea of resources covers a huge number of different things. For early settlers the most important resources were fuel, building materials and food. Settlements grew in areas where wood was plentiful, stone easily accessible and good soil allowed agriculture to be developed.

Since in early days of settlement many different resources have become the focal points for the growth of urban areas. Some of the settlements based on the resources are listed below:

6. Mining

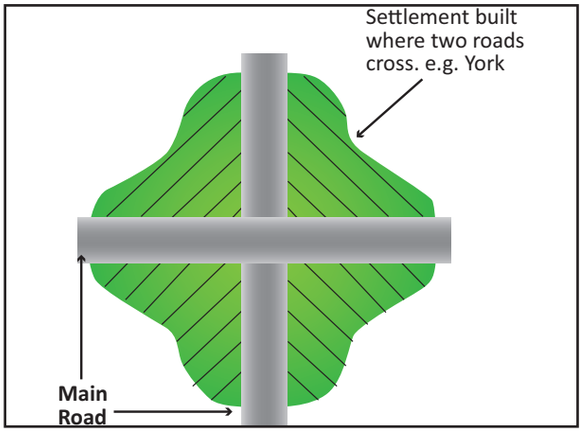
The coal mines of South Wales, Tin mines of Cornwall and large mining projects at Carajas in Northern Brazil, have all encouraged the rapid growth of settlements aimed at housing the workers and providing them with all that they re0quire.

7. Precious metals

Settlements in South Africa have grown after the discovery of large deposits of precious metals such as gold. The most famous settlement grew due to finding gold is San Francisco, after the gold rush to California in 1849.

8. Route centres

Route centres are often called Nodal Points. Nodal Points are formed by the meeting of two valleys, but settlement nowadays will grow where two main roads meet. In the UK, York is a good example of a route centre. Birmingham also enjoys a very good location, where many routes join up, and this is one of the reasons for its growth to become one of the largest cities in the UK.

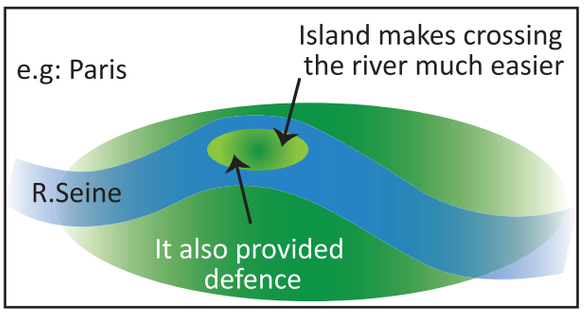


9. Bridging points

Just as water is very important for drinking, fishing, irrigation and navigation, so the ability to cross the rivers is also very important.

Many towns and cities have built up at points where it was the easiest to cross a large river. Exeter is one such example, crossing the river Exe in England.

However one of the best examples is Paris in France. The original town was based on the tiny Ile dela Cite, which is an island in the middle of the River Seine. This island meant they could build two small bridges across the river rather than one large one.



Nowadays the island has been engulfed by the huge city that Paris has become, however it does still have many bridges going to it and is

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